NARRATION SCRIPT · ARC FORMAT

POV: You're 40 and You Work for Your Younger Brother



— Nobody at the company knows you own 24%

2,367	~15 min	9	154
WORDS	RUNTIME	CHAPTERS	WORDS / MIN

Interactive: tap chapters to jump, tick boxes, type notes. Bookmarks panel lists every chapter.

Best in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Xodo, Foxit or a desktop browser so ticks and notes save.

NARRATION SCRIPT

POV: You Work for Your Younger Brother

Tap a chapter to jump to it.

2,367 words · ~15.3 min
9 chapters

Read each chapter aloud or send it to your voice tool, then tick the boxes as you finish recording, images and edit. Timecodes assume about 154 words per minute, the measured pace of the Michael voiceover.

#	CHAPTER	TIME	WORDS	PROGRESS
1	**The All-Hands** Age 40 · "Danny gave him a job."	00:00–02:00	310	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
2	**The Check** Age 28 · $38,400 and one condition	02:00–04:31	388	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
3	**The Smart One** Ages 29–35 · The page on the refrigerator	04:31–05:45	191	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
4	**Operations** Age 36 · The desk by the supply closet	05:45–07:49	321	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
5	**The Story He Believes** Age 37 · "Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me."	07:49–08:47	148	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
6	**The Year It Almost Disappears** Age 38 · Your hand on the boardroom door	08:47–10:08	210	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
7	**The Refrigerator** Age 39 · "Soon, Dad."	10:08–11:34	220	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
8	**Twenty-Four Percent** Age 40 · The ownership table	11:34–13:35	311	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited
9	**The Toast** Age 40 · "You just let your brother hold it."	13:35–15:19	268	☐ Recorded ☐ Images ☐ Edited

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

The All-Hands

Age 40 · "Danny gave him a job."

00:00 – 02:00
310 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

00:00 It's 8:15 on a Monday morning, and you're standing at the back of a converted warehouse with a coffee in a paper cup. Two hundred people sit in rows of folding chairs. Up front, under a banner that says ROUTEWISE, your little brother adjusts a microphone.

00:17 Danny is thirty-four. Gray vest. White sneakers that cost more than your first car.

00:23 You are forty. Your badge says Operations. Not Director. Not Head of. Just Operations. Somebody printed it wrong two years ago, and nobody ever fixed it.

00:33 Danny starts the story. You know it by heart. Everyone here does. The garage. The two laptops. The extension cord running from the kitchen. Twelve years ago, he says, I had nothing. No money. No investors. Nobody who believed in me. I built this alone.

00:50 Two hundred people clap.

00:52 A new hire in the row in front of you leans toward the woman beside him. Who's the guy in the back? he whispers.

01:01 That's his brother, she whispers back. Danny gave him a job.

01:06 You sip your coffee. It's cold already.

01:08 In your wallet, behind your license, there's a piece of paper folded into a square so small it's gone soft at the edges. A check stub. Twelve years old. Pay to the order of Routewise LLC. Thirty-eight thousand dollars.

01:23 Nobody in this room knows it exists. Not the new hires. Not the board. Not Danny's wife. Not your father.

01:31 Only Danny. And some days, you're not sure he remembers.

01:35 Here's what nobody tells you about working for your younger brother. The hard part isn't taking orders. It's watching everyone decide who you are, and deciding not to correct them. This is how the brother everyone pitied turned out to own almost a quarter of the company. And why he kept quiet for twelve years, even when it cost him everything except the money.

← Chapter overview Next: The Check →

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

The Check

Age 28 · $38,400 and one condition

02:00 – 04:31
388 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

02:00 Twelve years earlier, you're twenty-eight, sitting in a bank branch on Fulton Avenue with your name on the door.

02:07 Assistant manager. $61,000 a year. You've been saving for a house since you were twenty-four. Every month, $800. No vacations. No new car. The savings account is up to $38,400. One more year, and you'll have a down payment.

02:22 Your father is proud of you in the way he's proud of things that don't surprise him. You were the steady one. The one who finished things.

02:33 Danny was the other one.

02:35 Danny dropped out of college after three semesters. A band. A food truck. A golf app. Your father called every one of them the same thing. Another one of Danny's hobbies.

02:47 That spring, Danny is twenty-two and living in your parents' garage. Two laptops on a folding table. An extension cord running under the kitchen door. He's building software that tells small delivery companies the fastest route for every driver, every morning.

03:03 He shows it to you on a Sunday. A bakery across town already pays him $200 a month for it. Then a flower shop. Then a pharmacy.

03:13 He needs servers. A developer. Six months of rent somewhere that isn't a garage.

03:19 He doesn't ask you for money. He asks you what you think he should do.

03:25 You drive home and look at your savings account for a long time. $38,400. Four years of saying no to things.

03:33 The next week, a lawyer you went to high school with draws up a simple paper. Thirty-eight thousand dollars for thirty percent of Routewise. He asks if you're sure. You say yes before he finishes the sentence.

03:47 Then you add one condition. Not in the paperwork. Just between you and Danny.

03:53 Nobody knows. Not Dad. Not anyone. Out loud, it's always yours.

03:57 Danny looks at you like you've lost your mind. Why?

04:01 You don't explain. You can't say it out loud. That your father has called him a hobby for six years. That just once, you want Danny to have something nobody can take credit for.

04:14 He signs. You sign. You write the check at your kitchen table. Your hand doesn't shake.

04:20 You tell your father you decided to wait on the house. Market's too high, you say. He nods. Smart, he says. You were always the smart one.

← Chapter overview

Next: The Smart One →

CHAPTER 3 OF 9

The Smart One

Ages 29–35 · The page on the refrigerator

04:31 – 05:45
191 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

04:31 Then come the years where it looks like Danny is the smart one.

04:36 Routewise gets an office. Then investors. Every round, your thirty percent shrinks. Twenty-eight. Twenty-six. Twenty-four. The slice gets smaller. The pie gets much bigger.

04:45 By the time Danny is twenty-nine, a business magazine puts him on a list. Thirty Under Thirty. There's a photo of him in front of a wall of screens, arms crossed.

04:57 Your father cuts it out and puts it on the refrigerator. It stays there for five years. The tape turns yellow.

05:05 You're still at the bank. A promotion. Then another one. $84,000. It's a good job. Nobody frames it.

05:12 At Thanksgiving, your father raises a glass. To Danny, he says. Who proved everybody wrong. Everybody laughs, because everybody includes your father.

05:21 Then he turns to you. Still at the bank, Mark? Still holding the fort?

05:26 You say yes. You pass the stuffing.

05:29 Later, in the kitchen, he puts a hand on your shoulder and asks the question he'll ask you for the next ten years.

05:38 When are you going to build something of your own?

05:42 You don't answer. You wash the gravy boat.

← Chapter overview

Next: Operations →

CHAPTER 4 OF 9

Operations

Age 36 · The desk by the supply closet

05:45 – 07:49
321 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

05:45 When you're thirty-six, the bank merges with a bigger bank. Your branch closes on a Friday. They give you a box, a cake from the grocery store, and eleven weeks of severance.

05:57 Two weeks later, Danny calls. Come work with us, he says. We need someone who actually knows how to run things.

06:05 You should say no. You know how it'll look. You say yes anyway, because the severance runs out in nine weeks, and because some part of you wants to see it. The thing you paid for.

06:19 Your title is Director of Operations. Your salary is $78,000. Less than the bank. You report to a vice president named Tyler. Tyler is twenty-nine. Tyler wears a fleece vest with the company logo and says circle back the way other people breathe.

06:36 On your first day, Tyler walks you to a desk by the supply closet. Danny speaks very highly of you, he says. Then he smiles in a way that tells you exactly what Danny said. Be nice to him. He's family.

06:52 You learn fast what that means.

06:54 It means meetings you hear about after they happen. The problems nobody else wants. The server outage at 2:40 on a Sunday morning, when you're the only one who picks up the phone.

07:07 You fix the outage by 5. You go home and sleep for three hours. On Monday, Danny posts about it online. Proud of this team for pulling together under pressure. Four hundred likes. He doesn't mention your name. Nobody notices it's missing.

07:23 At the company holiday party, Danny's wife, Kelsey, introduces you to a client. This is Danny's older brother, she says, warmly. He helps out with operations. Helps out. The client shakes your hand the way people shake hands at a funeral.

07:39 You could end it with one sentence. You know exactly which one.

07:44 You refill the coffee and walk back to your desk by the supply closet.

← Chapter overview

Next: The Story He Believes →

CHAPTER 5 OF 9

The Story He Believes

Age 37 · "Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me."

07:49 – 08:47
148 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

07:49 The worst part isn't the people who think you're a charity case.

07:54 It's Danny.

07:55 Because somewhere in the last six years, Danny started believing the story too. You see it in small things. The way he asks you, in front of Tyler, to grab the lunch order. The way he tells the garage story at conferences and the extension cord gets longer every time, and the number of people who believed in him stays at zero.

08:19 One night, you find him alone in the glass conference room.

08:23 You okay? you ask.

08:25 He doesn't look up. Do you ever think about it? he says. The check?

08:30 Every day, you want to say.

08:33 Sometimes, you say instead.

08:34 He nods. Then he says something you'll replay for years. Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me. Is that bad?

08:42 You tell him to go home. You turn off the lights behind him.

← Chapter overview

Next: The Year It Almost Disappears →

CHAPTER 6 OF 9

The Year It Almost Disappears

Age 38 · Your hand on the boardroom door

08:47 – 10:08
210 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

08:47 Then comes the year it almost all disappears.

08:50 You're thirty-eight. A competitor cuts its prices in half. Two of the biggest clients leave in the same month. The cash runway shrinks from eighteen months to three.

09:01 In a board meeting you're not invited to, an investor suggests selling for parts. Twelve million dollars. Enough to pay back the investors. Nothing for anyone else.

09:11 You read the minutes the next morning. Your twenty-four percent of nothing is nothing.

09:17 That's the closest you ever come to saying it. You stand outside the boardroom with your hand on the door. You're a shareholder. One sentence, and every person who ever called you a charity case would know.

09:31 You let go of the door handle.

09:34 Instead, you call every client who left. You drive to their offices. You sit in their waiting rooms. You fix the things nobody fixed.

09:43 It takes four months. You win both back. Then a third you never had.

09:49 The company survives. At the next all-hands, Danny thanks the whole team for believing. Tyler gets a bonus. You get a new badge. It still says Operations.

09:59 Something changes in you that year. You stop checking what the company is worth. The number becomes something you own. Not something you are.

← Chapter overview

Next: The Refrigerator →

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

The Refrigerator

Age 39 · "Soon, Dad."

10:08 – 11:34
220 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

10:08 And around that time, the cost starts showing up somewhere you didn't expect.

10:13 Your father gets sick. Slowly, the way old men get sick. His hands shake. He forgets words. Danny visits on Sundays, between flights. You visit every Tuesday and Thursday. Nobody at the office notices when you leave.

10:28 One Thursday, your father is sitting at the kitchen table, staring at the magazine page on the refrigerator. The yellow tape is peeling at one corner.

10:38 I worry about you, he says. Not Danny. Danny's going to be fine. But you. You put your whole life into other people's things. The bank. Your brother. When are you going to build something of your own?

10:53 You look at the photo. At the arms crossed. At the wall of screens your thirty-eight thousand dollars paid for.

11:00 You almost tell him.

11:02 But he's tired, and his hands are shaking, and he looks at that page on the refrigerator the way he never looked at anything you did. And you realize that if you tell him, you'd be taking it away from him too. The one story about his youngest son that ended the way he hoped.

11:23 You tape the corner of the page back down.

11:27 Soon, Dad, you say.

11:28 You hate yourself on the drive home. You also know you'd do it again.

← Chapter overview

Next: Twenty-Four Percent →

CHAPTER 8 OF 9

Twenty-Four Percent

Age 40 · The ownership table

11:34 – 13:35
311 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

11:34 Which brings you back to the warehouse.

11:37 The all-hands. The banner. The cold coffee in the paper cup.

11:41 Three weeks ago, a national logistics company offered to buy Routewise. One hundred forty million dollars. The papers were signed on Friday. Up front, Danny talks about the journey. The vision. Then he says it again. I built this alone.

11:56 After the meeting, Tyler finds you by the coffee machine, holding a printout. The buyer's lawyers sent the final ownership table. Every shareholder. Every percentage.

12:06 Your name is the second line. Twenty-four percent. Right under Danny.

12:10 Tyler looks at the paper. Then at you. Then at the paper again. You report to me, he says. It's not a question. It's a man trying to make the room make sense.

12:23 For four years, you say.

12:25 He opens his mouth. Closes it. Then he says the only thing he can think of. Do you want a better desk?

12:34 You laugh. No, you say. I like the supply closet. It's quiet.

12:38 By lunch, the whole building knows. The new hire who whispered in the back row brings you a coffee you didn't ask for. You thank him. You mean it.

12:50 That night, Danny finds you in the parking lot. It's almost empty. The lights buzz. He's holding his car keys and not using them.

12:59 I said it again, he says. Alone. In front of everyone.

13:03 I know. I was there.

13:05 Why didn't you ever stop me? he asks. Any day. Any meeting. You could have told them all.

13:12 Because it was never mine to tell, you say. It was yours to say.

13:18 He's quiet for a long time. Then he puts his keys back in his pocket.

13:23 The wire hits your account on a Wednesday. More zeros than you ever let yourself picture. You read it twice. You go to work. Your badge still says Operations.

← Chapter overview

Next: The Toast →

CHAPTER 9 OF 9

The Toast

Age 40 · "You just let your brother hold it."

13:35 – 15:19
268 words

DIRECTOR NOTES

13:35 On Sunday, there's a family dinner at your father's house. He sits at the head of the table, smaller than he used to be.

13:44 Before anyone eats, Danny stands up with a glass. Your father beams. He's heard this toast before.

13:51 Twelve years ago, Danny says, I was in that garage with two laptops and an extension cord. And everyone thinks I did it alone.

14:00 He looks at you.

14:01 I didn't. There was a check. Thirty-eight thousand dollars. It was supposed to be a house.

14:08 He tells all of it. The condition. The outage at 2:40 in the morning. The four months of waiting rooms.

14:15 Your father looks at you. Then at the refrigerator. Then back at you. His hand shakes when he reaches across the table, and you're not sure it's the illness.

14:27 You never said, he says.

14:29 No, you say.

14:30 He holds your wrist for a long moment.

14:33 You did build something of your own, he says quietly. You just let your brother hold it.

14:39 After dinner, you wash the gravy boat, the way you always do. Your father takes the towel and dries.

14:47 You take the check stub out of your wallet. Twelve years, folded into a square. You unfold it, smooth it flat, and tape it to the refrigerator, right next to the magazine page.

15:00 Here's what nobody tells you about working for your younger brother. People will measure you by your badge. By your desk. By who stands at the front of the room.

15:11 They'll get the math wrong.

15:13 And the people worth keeping are the ones who learn to say it right.

← Chapter overview

End of script